

Last time Counting

MP, $P(n, k)$, $\binom{n}{k}$

formula/
identity

$$P(n, k) = \binom{n}{k} k!$$

"Counting"
argument

arrange k of n objects
① choose k of n objects
② arrange k chosen objects

Lesson 12 Combinatorial Proofs

Prop 1 If $|A| = n$, then $|\mathcal{P}(A)| = 2^n$.

the set of all
subsets of A

(If A has 3 elements, A has $2^3 = 8$ subsets)

Proof To count the # of subsets of $A = \{a_1, \dots, a_n\}$
we think of a subset as a series of decisions
to include or exclude each element a_k , $k=1, \dots, n$.

Aside $A = \{1, 2, 3\}$
 $\{1\} \leftrightarrow (1, 0, 0)$
↑ ↑
include exclude
the 1st the 2nd and 3rd
element elements.

$\{2\} \leftrightarrow (0, 1, 0)$

$\{1, 3\} \leftrightarrow (1, 0, 1)$

0, 1
3-element binary
list

Each subset corresponds to a n -element binary list.

$$\begin{aligned} \# \text{ of subsets} &= \# \text{ of } n\text{-element binary lists} \\ &= \underbrace{2 \times 2 \times \dots \times 2}_n = 2^n \\ &\quad \begin{array}{c} 2 \quad 2 \quad \dots \quad - \quad - \\ \hline 0, 1 \quad \dots \end{array} \end{aligned}$$

Prop 2 let n be a nonnegative integer, then

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} = 2^n \quad \text{identity/formula}$$

$$\left[\binom{n}{0} + \binom{n}{1} + \binom{n}{2} + \dots + \binom{n}{n} \right]$$

$k=0 \quad k=1 \quad k=2 \quad \quad \quad k=n$

algebraic proof: $\binom{n}{k} = \frac{n!}{(n-k)!k!}$

(combinatorial)

Proof From Prop 1, the RHS, 2^n , is the # of subsets of an n -element set A . We will show that the sum on the LHS ^{also} counts the # of subsets of A .

Recall that $\binom{n}{k}$ is the # of k -element subsets of an n -element set.

A has $\binom{n}{0}$ subsets w/ 0 element

A .. $\binom{n}{1}$... w/ 1 element

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \dots & \binom{n}{2} & \dots & 2 \text{ elements} \\ & \vdots & & \\ \dots & \binom{n}{n} & \dots & n \text{ elements} \end{array}$$

The total # of subsets of A is n
 $\binom{n}{0} + \binom{n}{1} + \binom{n}{2} + \dots + \binom{n}{n} = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k}$

Binomial Theorem $n \in \mathbb{Z}, n \geq 0$

$$(x+y)^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} x^{n-k} y^k$$

$\binom{n}{k}$ $\leftarrow$ binomial coef

$$n=0: (x+y)^0 = \binom{0}{0} x^{0-0} y^0 = 1 \cdot 1 \cdot 1 = 1$$

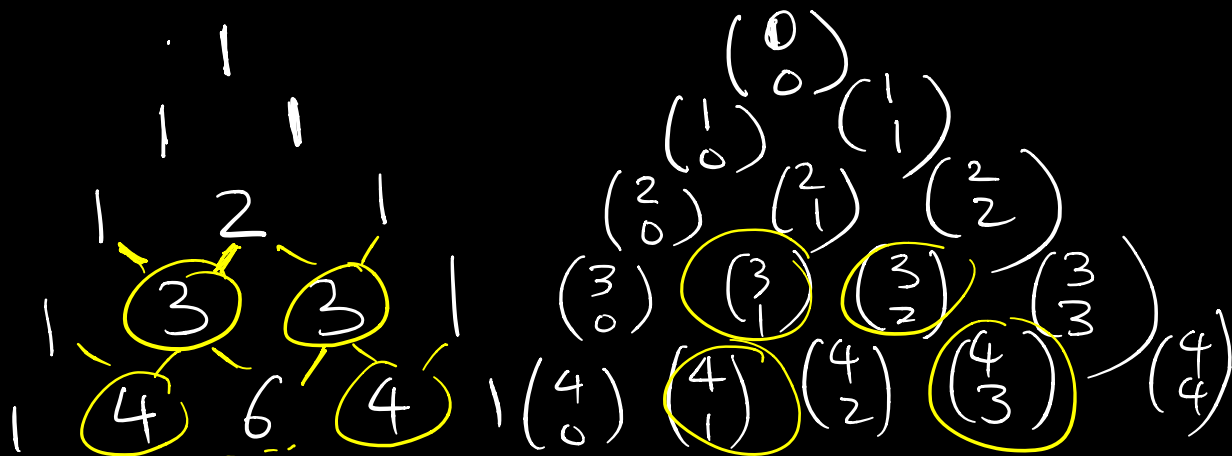
$$n=1: (x+y)^1 = \binom{1}{0} x^{1-0} y^0 + \binom{1}{1} x^{1-1} y^1$$

$$= x + y$$

$$n=2: (x+y)^2 = \binom{2}{0} x^2 + \binom{2}{1} xy + \binom{2}{2} y^2$$

$$n=3: (x+y)^3 = \binom{3}{0} x^3 + \binom{3}{1} x^2 y + \binom{3}{2} x y^2 + \binom{3}{3} y^3$$

Pascal's Triangle



proof
next
time

$$\begin{cases} \binom{n}{k} = \binom{n}{n-k} \\ \binom{n}{k} = \binom{n-1}{k-1} + \binom{n-1}{k} \end{cases}$$

Binomial Thm:

$$(a+b)^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} a^{n-k} b^k$$

Proof $(x+y)^n = \underbrace{(x+y)(x+y)\cdots(x+y)}_n$
 When expanded, we have a sum of terms $x^i y^j$ because we get exactly one x or y from each factor $(x+y)$. Moreover, $i+j=n$.

So, if there are k y 's,
we have $(n-k)$ x 's.

How many $x^{n-k} y^k$ terms?

The answer is the # of ways
we choose k y 's from n factors,
that is, $\binom{n}{k}$.

Finally we sum from $k=0$ to n
because we can have $0, 1, 2, \dots, n$
 y 's in each term.